

News & Media (English)

Subject (Classification)	English (Elective)	Credit(s)	3	Teacher(s)	Juhwan Kim	Classroom	2409-2
Google Classroom	fu6nbwt	Class Hours/W	3	Contact (Email/Phone/Office)			
				amstkim@gmail.com	051)606-2217	2309-2	

1. Overview

Course Description				
As part of the Korea Science Academy's English education curriculum, <i>News and Media English</i> is designed to help students enhance their English proficiency at a high-intermediate level. This course will focus on exploring contemporary issues in both domestic and international contexts through diverse media sources. Students will engage with various texts, videos, and articles to develop their skills in academic reading, speaking, and writing in English. Throughout the course, students will participate in both small-group and whole-class activities to practice their communication skills. They will also gain valuable experience in delivering oral presentations to large audiences, honing their public speaking abilities. By the end of the course, students will have improved their ability to discuss and present complex ideas with confidence in English.				
Objectives				
The following list includes specific objectives of the course: • To demonstrate effective listening skills • To read and demonstrate comprehension of articles in preparation for presentations • To write paragraphs and essays on topics related to class assignments • To use common and useful expressions of English language for discussion • To demonstrate effective interpersonal and intercultural communication style • To facilitate a group discussion • To discuss and describe problems and offer solutions				
CORE Competencies				
Critical Thinking	Communication (in English)	Insights	Empathy	Team Leadership

- **Critical thinking** is the intellectually disciplined process of actively and skillfully conceptualizing, applying, analyzing, synthesizing, and/or evaluating information gathered from, or generated by, observation, experience, reflection, reasoning, or communication, as a guide to belief and action.
- **Communication** refers to the ability of an individual to accurately convey a message to another person or group of people. There are verbal and non-verbal communication skills. In this course, it also refers to the skill for communication using the English language.
- **Insights:** From a liberal arts perspective, insight refers to immediate and clear learning or understanding that takes place without overt trial-and-error testing. Insight occurs in human learning when people recognize relationships (or make novel associations between objects or actions) that can help them solve new problems.
- **Empathy**, an essential aspect of education and social-emotional learning competencies is "the ability to recognize, appreciate, and understand another's state of mind or emotions, to be receptive to new ideas and perspectives, and to see, appreciate, and value differences and diversity in others." (Turner et al., "Standards for a course of study for teaching SEL skills K-8. 2019).
- **Team leadership** refers to one's competence that supports the diverse skills, needs, goals, perspectives, and expectations of independent teachers while connecting the work of the team with the broad organizational goals.

2. Textbook & References

- No Textbook Required. Handouts will be provided.
- Study Materials: Online/Offline News Media and Periodicals (Arirang, CNN, BBC, TED, YouTube, Breaking News English, *Time*, *Discover*, *National Geographic*, *Wired*, *Korea Herald*, etc.)

3. Course Requirements & Assessment

Attendance	Participation	Quiz and Short Writing	Oral Presentation (2 Speeches)	Written Test (Mid-term Exam)
15%	20%	15%	30%	20%

- Attendance: Regular and consistent attendance is expected. Any absence without prior permission and proper documentation will significantly impact the final grade.

Being late by more than 10 minutes will be considered an absence. A tardy is defined as being late by more than 5 minutes, and two tardies will count as one absence.

- **Class Participation:** Students are expected to read the assigned materials before class and be prepared to discuss their thoughts and ideas. Strong participation includes actively listening to peers, asking and answering questions, making relevant comments, and staying engaged during class. Participation credit is evaluated in every session and is a key factor in determining the final grade.
- **Quiz & In-Class Writing:** This component of the course is designed to ensure students are consistently engaging with class materials and developing their ability to express complex ideas succinctly in written English. Content and Focus: Quizzes and writing tasks will be based directly on class content, including assigned texts from sources like National Geographic, Time, and Breaking News English, as well as handouts and lectures:
 - **Vocabulary Development:** Assessments will include "Vocab Work" and specific vocabulary quizzes throughout the semester to reinforce the terminology encountered in various news media.
 - **Short Writing Tasks:** Students will regularly perform short in-class writing assignments. These tasks aim to help students practice writing paragraphs and essays on topics related to current domestic and international issues
- **Oral Presentations (Speeches):** Students will deliver two oral presentations in class: a 5–7 minute personal narrative speech and a 10–12 minute academic presentation. Detailed instructions, including the rubric for assessment will be provided later in class.
- **Written Test:** Final exam will be a written test with a combination of multiple-choice questions, short-answer questions, and a short writing task. Questions will be based on class content, including assigned texts, handouts, and lectures. (Note: In the event of an absence from the written exam, the case shall be handled in accordance with the school's academic management regulations. Following the guidelines of the Department of Humanities and Arts, the grade will be replaced by performance assessment scores.
- **Final Grades:** Final grades will be determined based on the total points earned, using the following scale: A+ (95~100), A0 (90~94), A- (88~89), B+ (85~87), B0 (80~84), B- (78~79), C+ (75~77), C0 (70~74), C- (68~69), D+ (65~67), D0 (60~64), D- (58~59), F (57 and below)

4. Weekly Schedule

* The following schedule is subject to change upon necessity. Any change will be announced ahead in class. Each class will include a variety of activities such as vocab work, short lectures, in-class reading/writing, multimedia screening, Q&A, and discussion. Handouts and supplementary materials will be used as needed.

Week	Themes and Activities	Tasks and Notes
1	Course Overview & Introduction - Listening: News Headlines (Arirang, BBC, CNN, etc.)	

Week	Themes and Activities	Tasks and Notes
	- Other Activities: Vocab. Work, Q&A, Quiz, Discussion, Short Writing	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
2	- Listening: News Headlines (Arirang, BBC, CNN, etc.) - Reading: <i>National Geographic</i> Other Activities: Vocab. Work, Q&A, Quiz, Discussion, Short Writing	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
3	- Listening: News Headlines (Arirang, BBC, CNN, etc.) - Reading: <i>Discover</i> - Other Activities: Vocab. Work, Q&A, Quiz, Discussion, Short Writing	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
4	- Listening: News Headlines (Arirang, BBC, CNN, etc.) - Reading: <i>Time</i> - Other Activities: Vocab. Work, Q&A, Quiz, Discussion, Short Writing	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
5	Speeches by Students	Oral Presentation #1
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
6	- Listening: News Headlines (Arirang, BBC, CNN, etc.) - Reading: Articles from <i>Breaking News English</i> - Other Activities: Vocab. Work, Q&A, Quiz, Discussion, Short Writing	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
7	- Listening: News Headlines (Arirang, BBC, CNN, etc.) - Reading: <i>National Geographic</i> - Other Activities: Vocab. Work, Q&A, Quiz, Discussion, Short Writing	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
8	Mid-term Exam Week	No Class
9	- Listening: News Headlines (Arirang, BBC, CNN, etc.) - Reading: <i>Discover</i> - Other Activities: Vocab. Work, Q&A, Quiz, Discussion, Short Writing	

Week	Themes and Activities	Tasks and Notes
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
10	- Listening: News Headlines (Arirang, BBC, CNN, etc.) - Reading: Time - Other Activities: Vocab. Work, Q&A, Quiz, Discussion, Short Writing	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
11	- Listening: News Headlines (Arirang, BBC, CNN, etc.) - Reading: Articles from Breaking News English - Other Activities: Vocab. Work, Q&A, Quiz, Discussion, Short Writing	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
12	Speeches by Students	Oral Presentation #2 Due
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
13	- Listening: News Headlines (Arirang, BBC, CNN, etc.) - Reading: <i>National Geographic</i> - Other Activities: Vocab. Work, Q&A, Quiz, Discussion, Short Writing	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
14	- Listening: News Headlines (Arirang, BBC, CNN, etc.) - Reading: <i>Discover</i> - Other Activities: Vocab. Work, Q&A, Quiz, Discussion, Short Writing	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
15	- Listening: News Headlines (Arirang, BBC, CNN, etc.) - Reading: <i>Time</i> - Other Activities: Vocab. Work, Q&A, Quiz, Discussion, Short Writing	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
16	- Listening: News Headlines (Arirang, BBC, CNN, etc.) - Reading: <i>Time</i> - Other Activities: Vocab. Work, Q&A, Quiz, Discussion, Short Writing	
CORE competencies	Communication, Critical Thinking, Insights, Empathy, Team Leadership	
17	Final Exam Week (No Class)	No Class

■ Competency Assessment Form and Rubrics

CORE Competencies	Not Demonstrated	Emerging	Developing	Proficient	Advanced
	(Weak)	(Needs Improvement)	(Acceptable)	(Strong)	(Excellent)
Critical Thinking					
Creativity					
Communication					
Insights					
Empathy					
Team Leadership					

Critical Thinking Rubric (Evaluating News and Media Bias)

Category	0 - Not Demonstrated	1 - Emerging	2 - Developing	3 - Proficient	4 - Advanced
Identifying Bias	Does not recognize bias in news/media sources.	Identifies bias inconsistently but lacks depth in explanation.	Recognizes bias but does not fully support claims with evidence.	Identifies and explains bias with supporting evidence.	Thoroughly analyzes bias with strong evidence and considers multiple perspectives.
Evaluating Sources	Does not assess credibility.	Recognizes some credibility factors but lacks consistency.	Evaluates sources based on limited criteria.	Consistently applies credibility criteria.	Critically evaluates sources with strong reasoning and justification.
Argumentation	Provides unsupported opinions.	Makes basic claims with minimal evidence.	Supports claims with relevant but limited evidence.	Constructs well-supported arguments using multiple sources.	Synthesizes diverse sources into a compelling, well-supported argument.

Creativity Rubric (Media Content Creation)

Category	0 - Not Demonstrated	1 - Emerging	2 - Developing	3 - Proficient	4 - Advanced
Originality	Does not show creative effort.	Shows minimal originality with basic ideas.	Ideas show some creativity but may be derivative.	Demonstrates original thinking with creative approaches.	Presents highly original ideas that challenge norms.
Storytelling Techniques	Lacks structure and engagement.	Uses basic storytelling but lacks coherence.	Incorporates storytelling elements with some effectiveness.	Uses engaging storytelling techniques effectively.	Masterfully crafts a compelling and engaging narrative.
Use of Multimedia	Does not incorporate multimedia.	Uses basic media elements with little impact.	Includes relevant media with moderate effectiveness.	Integrates multimedia effectively to enhance communication.	Skillfully blends multiple media formats for maximum impact.

Communication (English) Rubric (Oral Presentation)

Category	0 - Not Demonstrated	1 - Emerging	2 - Developing	3 - Proficient	4 - Advanced
Clarity & Coherence	Speech is unclear and difficult to follow.	Ideas are disorganized and somewhat unclear.	Speech is mostly clear but lacks strong organization.	Ideas are well-organized and presented clearly.	Presentation is highly structured, fluent, and engaging.
Pronunciation & Fluency	Speech is difficult to understand.	Pronunciation is unclear, with frequent hesitations.	Some pronunciation issues but mostly understandable.	Clear pronunciation and confident delivery.	Excellent pronunciation, intonation, and confident fluency.
Audience Engagement	No engagement with audience.	Minimal eye contact or interaction.	Some effort to engage the audience.	Engages audience effectively.	Captivates and maintains audience attention throughout.

Insights Rubric (Media Analysis & Reflection)

Category	0 - Not Demonstrated	1 - Emerging	2 - Developing	3 - Proficient	4 - Advanced
Depth of Reflection	No reflection or personal insight.	Minimal personal insight with limited analysis.	Reflects on media topics with basic understanding.	Demonstrates deep reflection with well-developed insights.	Provides profound insights, making strong personal and societal connections.
Application of Concepts	Does not apply course concepts.	Attempts to apply concepts but inconsistently.	Applies concepts with moderate success.	Uses course concepts effectively.	Integrates course concepts seamlessly into insightful reflections.

Empathy Rubric (Understanding Diverse Perspectives in Media)

Category	0 - Not Demonstrated	1 - Emerging	2 - Developing	3 - Proficient	4 - Advanced
Perspective-Taking	Does not acknowledge different perspectives.	Recognizes other perspectives but lacks depth.	Acknowledges multiple viewpoints with basic reasoning.	Analyzes perspectives with clear understanding.	Shows deep empathy, considering historical, cultural, and societal contexts.
Respectful Discussion	Engages disrespectfully or not at all.	Engages minimally in discussions.	Participates but struggles with respectful disagreement.	Communicates respectfully and thoughtfully.	Demonstrates advanced diplomacy, actively fostering inclusive discussions.

Team Leadership Rubric (Group Projects & Collaboration)

Category	0 - Not Demonstrated	1 - Emerging	2 - Developing	3 - Proficient	4 - Advanced
Collaboration & Teamwork	Does not contribute to team efforts.	Contributes minimally, with little interaction.	Works with teammates but lacks strong collaboration.	Collaborates effectively, sharing responsibilities.	Leads by example, inspiring and guiding team members.
Problem-Solving	Avoids resolving team issues.	Struggles to address conflicts or challenges.	Participates in problem-solving but lacks initiative.	Actively contributes to solutions.	Demonstrates outstanding leadership in resolving conflicts and improving teamwork.
Responsibility & Initiative	Does not complete assigned tasks.	Completes tasks only with reminders.	Meets responsibilities but takes minimal initiative.	Takes initiative and fulfills tasks responsibly.	Proactively leads and supports the team beyond expectations.



Pledge of Academic Integrity

Academic integrity is a commitment to honest and moral behavior in an academic setting. All members of KSA, an academic institution and community, share the same commitment and therefore must be responsible for any violation of the honor code that is to be regulated by the school.

Violation of the academic honor code includes:

- Giving your work (homework, exams, answer key for homework and/or exams, feedback regarding exams, etc.) to other students
- Accepting or copying homework from another student who gave you the answers
- Paying someone else to write your paper or do your homework
- Cheat sheet used for closed book exams
- Stealing the test
- Collaborating on work that the teacher expects to be done independently
- Plagi

Year/Semester: 2026-1 (Spring)

Course Title: News & Media English

Teacher: Juhwan Kim

All assignments in this class are expected to be students' own, completed by themselves specifically for this class. If students receive tutoring or any other help, in person or online, they must indicate that on the assignment, including any relevant links or contact information of the assistants. For everything in this class, all sources must be cited. Sharing course materials with anyone outside the class is prohibited. All use of commercial homework assistance for anything related to this course is prohibited, and considered an honor code violation.

I affirm and pledge that I will not plagiarize, use unauthorized materials, or give or receive illegitimate help on assignments, papers or examinations. I will uphold fairness and honesty in my work and the work of others.

Student Printed Name:

Signature:

Date: